Warm-up / Two bottle reports

Trust the method, not just the name

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 30 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Method: How information was gathered and checked.

Financial interest: A way someone could gain money from acceptance of a claim.

Comparison group: A group used to help judge what difference an action makes.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A bottle seller promises its bottle keeps water cold, with no test details. A consumer group publishes a timed test of that bottle and two rivals, using equal starting temperatures and room conditions. It does not disclose who funded the test. No temperature results are supplied.

Produce: Write the easier-to-check report, one reason, and one missing detail.

Your steps

1. Choose the report that describes more of its testing method.
2. Name a stated detail that makes its comparison easier to inspect.
3. Name the missing funding detail and explain why you cannot yet decide which bottle performs best.

Before you finish: Have you used the stated method rather than the organization's name alone?

Your response

Main activity / Compare the sleep-app sources

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: An app seller says its product improves sleep, citing 12 testimonials with no recruitment details or sleep measure. A university team studies the same app: 200 adults are randomly assigned to app or no-app groups, sleep is measured identically, and the complete results and funding are disclosed. No result figures are supplied here; you are judging how checkable the sources are.

Produce: Make a two-row comparison chart and write two sentences evaluating how checkable the reports are.

Your steps

1. Make a two-row chart, one row per source, with columns for participant selection, measurement, comparison group, and disclosed interests.
2. Write 'not supplied' wherever the scenario lacks a detail; do not invent it.
3. Write two sentences identifying which report is easier to check and why a seller's financial interest is a reason for scrutiny rather than automatic disproof.

Before you finish: Did you compare reporting methods rather than trust the university's name or reject the seller's identity alone?

Your response

Exit ticket / Checking a light-bulb claim

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A bulb maker says its bulbs use less electricity, citing three customers without test details. A local school reports testing its bulbs and a rival model for equal hours at the same light output, publishes all electricity readings, and says the maker donated both sets of bulbs. The readings themselves are not supplied here.

Produce: Compare the methods, identify a disclosed interest and a missing detail, and state what you can judge.

Your steps

1. Identify which report gives more checkable testing details and name two of them.
2. State the school's disclosed support and one question you would ask about how bulbs were selected.
3. Explain why the school report is more checkable but these facts do not tell you which bulb uses less electricity.

Before you finish: Have you treated donated equipment as something to examine, rather than automatic proof of a false claim?

Your response